

Nielsen Norman Group Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
Date:
Product:
Task:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

No major usability issues were identified under the Visibility of System Status heuristic during the evaluation process. Most respondents were able to clearly understand the current state of the system through the use of confirmation messages, highlighted navigation elements, vaccination status indicators, and updated appointment information. Users were generally informed about the results of their actions without noticeable delays or confusion while interacting with the prototype.

Recommendations

Some respondents suggested additional advanced features and functionalities for the application. However, many of these suggestions exceeded the current capabilities, scope, and technical limitations of the prototype. These recommendations may be considered for future development and enhancement of the system if more resources and technical support become available.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some respondents were not fully familiar with certain technical or formal terms used in the System Usability Scale (SUS) questionnaire, particularly words such as "unnecessarily complex," "cumbersome," and "well integrated." A few participants required additional clarification before answering specific questionnaire items, as these terms were not commonly used in their everyday language or experience.

Recommendations

Since the System Usability Scale (SUS) questions are standardized and should not be modified, researchers may provide brief verbal explanations or simplified descriptions of unfamiliar terms before participants answer the questionnaire. This can help respondents better understand the meaning of each statement while still preserving the integrity of the SUS instrument.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Most respondents were able to navigate through the prototype, return to previous screens, and cancel certain actions without difficulty. However, the prototype had limited support for undo and redo functionalities, making it difficult for some users to fully reverse or recover actions once information had already been entered or confirmed.

Recommendations

Future versions of the application may consider implementing undo and redo functionalities, along with additional confirmation prompts or editable forms, to improve user control and allow users to correct mistakes more efficiently during system interaction.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

No major issues were identified regarding consistency and standards during the evaluation process. Most respondents were able to recognize and understand the interface elements, navigation structure, icons, buttons, and layouts because similar visual styles and design patterns were consistently used throughout the prototype. The system generally followed common mobile application conventions, making interactions more predictable and easier for users to understand.

Recommendations

The prototype should continue maintaining consistent visual styles, navigation patterns, button designs, icons, and terminology across all screens to preserve usability and familiarity for users. Future improvements may also focus on refining minor interface details and maintaining alignment with standard mobile application design conventions to further enhance the overall user experience.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

No major issues related to error prevention were identified during the evaluation process. The prototype included warning and confirmation prompts before users performed important actions, like canceling an appointment. These prompts allowed users to review their decisions before proceeding. Most respondents were able to interact with the system without encountering significant input or navigation errors.

Recommendations

Future versions of the application may further enhance error prevention by adding more input validations, clearer field requirements, and additional confirmation prompts for other important actions to improve accuracy and reduce user mistakes.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Most interface elements, navigation options, and important information within the prototype were visible and easy for respondents to recognize without needing to memorize actions or system processes. Users were generally able to identify vaccination records, appointment details, navigation tabs, and form fields easily during task completion. However, one respondent experienced difficulty locating the “Add Booking” icon because it was not immediately noticeable within the interface until it was pointed out during the evaluation process.

Recommendations

To improve discoverability, the “Add Booking” icon may be redesigned with a more noticeable visual treatment, such as increased size, stronger contrast, clearer labeling, or improved placement within the interface so users can identify it more easily without assistance.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The prototype supported touch gestures and standard mobile interactions that allowed users to navigate the application efficiently and complete tasks with minimal difficulty. In addition, the system provided personalized and customizable content for users, particularly through pet profiles, vaccination records, and appointment-related information. However, keyboard shortcuts and other advanced accelerators were not included because the prototype was primarily designed for mobile device interaction.

Recommendations

Additional interaction enhancements and advanced usability features may be explored in future developments to further improve accessibility, convenience, and overall system efficiency for users.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

No significant usability concerns were observed under the Aesthetic and Minimalist Design heuristic during the evaluation. The prototype presented a simple and well-structured interface that emphasized essential information and core system functionalities only. Most respondents were able to interact with the application comfortably since the screens were free from distracting visuals, unnecessary components, and excessive content. The overall arrangement of elements also helped maintain clarity and ease of navigation throughout the prototype.

Recommendations

The prototype should continue applying a clean and minimal interface design, as it helped users focus on important information and system functions more effectively. Future enhancements may further improve the visual presentation by refining layout alignment, spacing, and consistency while still maintaining a simple and distraction-free user experience.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

The prototype included basic confirmation and cancellation prompts that helped users avoid unintended actions, such as accidentally canceling appointments. However, more detailed error-handling features were limited within the current version of the prototype. The system did not fully provide specific error messages, recovery instructions, or guided solutions for resolving user mistakes, since the prototype mainly focused on demonstrating the intended workflow and interface interactions rather than complete system functionality.

Recommendations

Future improvements may include more comprehensive error-handling features, such as clearer validation messages, visual error indicators, and step-by-step guidance that can help users recognize problems and recover from mistakes more efficiently. Although the existing confirmation prompts supported basic error prevention, expanding the system's feedback and recovery mechanisms could further improve usability and user confidence during interaction.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The prototype did not include dedicated help documentation, tutorials, or searchable support features within the system. Since the application was designed as a prototype focused mainly on demonstrating core functionalities and interface flow, additional help-related components were not implemented during the development process. Despite this limitation, most respondents were still able to complete the given tasks and navigate the system without requiring extensive assistance.

Recommendations

In future versions of the application, we, the researchers may consider implementing help and documentation features such as user guides, FAQs, or contextual instructions to provide additional assistance for users during system interaction. Incorporating these support features could help improve user understanding, increase accessibility, and make the application easier to navigate, especially for first-time users.